

CAMPUS TAKES - BRAND INSTRUCTIONS

Reference document for AI-assisted design. Follow these rules exactly.

1. WHAT CAMPUS TAKES IS

Campus Takes recruits verified college students to take part in paid market and UX research: interviews, usability tests, and surveys. Research teams and brands pay to reach screened student participants. Students get paid for giving honest opinions.

Brand name: Campus Takes (two words, both capitalized)

Tagline: Verified students. Honest takes.

Website: campustakes.com

Contact: hello@campustakes.com

Two audiences. A design usually speaks to one or the other:

- a) Research teams and brands. Tone: credible, precise, calm.
- b) College students. Tone: warm, direct, plain. Money is the hook.

Do NOT add "LLC", "Inc", or any legal suffix to designs.

Do NOT reference or imply any specific university, college, or school.

Do NOT use university names, logos, mascots, or school colors.

2. COLOR - NAVY AND WHITE ONLY

This brand uses navy and white. There is NO third color.

No orange, no coral, no amber, no purple, no green, no gradient.

When something must stand out, use a LIGHTER SHADE OF THE SAME NAVY.

Introducing any contrasting hue is off-brand.

CORE PALETTE

#10254A	Navy	The brand color. Logo, headings, buttons, dark sections. Use for anything that must feel like the brand.
#FFFFFF	White	Page background. Also text placed on navy.
#33507F	Navy Soft	The ONLY accent. Links, hovers, small labels, secondary figures.
#0A1E3F	Navy Deep	Rare. Shadows and the darkest tints only.
#F7F8FA	Off White	Alternating section backgrounds, panels, chips.
#232B38	Text	Body copy. Warmer than navy and easier to read at length. Use for paragraphs, not headings.
#5A6472	Muted	Secondary text, captions, footers.
#E4E7EC	Line	Hairline rules, borders, dividers, table lines.

DATA AND CHART SHADES, darkest to lightest

#10254A	Tier 1, the largest or most important segment
#33507F	Tier 2
#9DAEC9	Tier 3
#C9D3E3	Empty, inactive, or remainder

COLOR RULES

- Default page: white background, #232B38 text, #10254A headings.
- For a dark section: #10254A background with #FFFFFF text.
- Never place #10254A text on a dark background.

- Never use pure black (#000000). Navy replaces black everywhere.
- Do not set body copy in #5A6472 or lighter. It fails contrast.

3. TYPOGRAPHY - TWO FONTS ONLY

HEADING FONT: Source Serif 4, SemiBold, weight 600

Use for headlines, section titles, the logo wordmark, and large numbers or statistics. On large headings tighten letter spacing to about -2 percent. In Canva, letter spacing around -20.

BODY FONT: Instrument Sans, weights 400, 500, 600, 700

Use for body copy, buttons, navigation, labels, and captions.

Both fonts are free on Google Fonts and available in Canva.

Do not substitute other fonts. Do not add a third font.

Never use a monospace font.

Never use Inter, Roboto, Arial, Montserrat, Poppins, or any default system font.

TYPE SCALE

Page headline (H1)	Source Serif 4	42-67 px	weight 600
Section heading (H2)	Source Serif 4	27-38 px	weight 600
Large figure or stat	Source Serif 4	34-54 px	weight 600
Card heading (H3)	Instrument Sans	17 px	weight 600
Body copy	Instrument Sans	17 px	weight 400
Caption, small print	Instrument Sans	13-15 px	weight 400
Eyebrow or kicker	Instrument Sans	12.5 px	weight 600
uppercase, letter spacing +9 percent			

4. LOGO

The logo is two overlapping speech bubbles with a curved gap between them, paired with the wordmark "Campus Takes" in Source Serif 4.

FILES AND WHEN TO USE THEM

campustakes-lockup-navy.png	Default logo. Light backgrounds.
campustakes-lockup-white.png	Navy, dark, or photo backgrounds.
campustakes-mark-navy.png	Mark only. Tight spaces, watermarks.
campustakes-mark-white.png	Mark only, on dark backgrounds.
campustakes-canva-icon.png	Square navy icon. Brand Kit icon slot, social profile pictures, avatars.
campustakes-icon-white.png	Square white icon, for dark platforms.

LOGO RULES

- Clear space: leave at least the height of one speech bubble on all four sides. Never crowd it.
- The mark aspect ratio is 1.23 to 1. Always lock the ratio.
- Minimum size: below roughly 120 px wide, drop the wordmark and use the mark alone.
- Use the white logo on anything dark, including photographs.

NEVER

- Stretch, squash, skew, or rotate the logo.

- Add a drop shadow, glow, outline, bevel, or gradient.
- Recolor it to anything other than navy or white.
- Place the navy logo on a dark background.
- Rebuild or retype the wordmark in a different font.
- Put the logo inside a badge or shape that is not one of the files.

5. LAYOUT AND DESIGN

The look is minimal, editorial, and calm. It should read like a well-designed professional company, not a generated landing page.

DO

- Use generous white space. Let the design breathe.
- Use hairline rules, #E4E7EC at 1 px, to divide content.
- Align text left in dense or data-heavy blocks so it is scannable.
- Pair a large number in Source Serif 4 with a short label beneath it.
- Alternate white and #F7F8FA sections for rhythm, with occasional full navy sections for contrast.
- Keep paragraph width to roughly 60 to 70 characters.

NEVER

- Gradients of any kind, including navy to blue.
- Decorative drop shadows, glows, or neon effects.
- Dot grids, mesh patterns, blobs, waves, or abstract 3D shapes.
- Stock photos of diverse teams or staged office scenes.
- Emoji used as icons.
- Rounded pill badges saying "New" or "Beta".
- Heavy borders. Rules should be 1 px hairlines.

6. VOICE AND COPYWRITING

Warm, confident, plain-spoken. Credible to a research director, approachable to a twenty year old.

WRITING RULES

- Say the thing plainly. Short sentences.
- Never use these words: elevate, seamless, unleash, next-gen, game-changing, revolutionary, cutting-edge, delve, tapestry, supercharge, effortless.
- Never use em dashes. Use a comma, a colon, or a full stop.
- Use sentence case for headings, not Title Case.
- Avoid exclamation marks. In student-facing copy, at most one.
- Write in active voice.

NUMBERS

- When citing a statistic, give the count next to the percentage.
Correct: "13 of 20 respondents", or "65 percent, 13 of 20".
Wrong: "65 percent" with no denominator anywhere.
- Small samples must state the sample size.

7. CLAIMS THAT MAY NOT BE MADE

These are hard prohibitions. Do not write any of them, in any wording, even if they sound plausible or persuasive.

- Any show rate or no-show rate figure. No client session has been run, so no such number exists.
- "95 percent" of anything.
- "Guaranteed", or any promise about an outcome.
- "Hard quotas filled" as a general or repeated capability.
- Payouts described as instant, immediate, or within minutes.
- Any count of colleges, universities, campuses, schools, or institutions. Not fifteen, not any number, and not phrases such as "campuses across the country".
- Client names, client logos, testimonials, reviews, or case studies. There are none. Never invent or imply them.
- Claims about the quality of interviews or usability sessions.
- Statements that a named attribute such as language, ethnicity, income, major, or heritage is a searchable field on a participant record.
- Broad claims about competitors presented as fact.
- "Hand-screened", "screened by hand", or any wording implying a person screens respondents by voice. In market research, "screening" a respondent means a recruiter interviews them, usually by phone. Campus Takes does NOT phone screen. Say "hand-picked" or "invited by hand" for the selection step, and "online screener" for the form.

WHAT MAY BE SAID

- A quota of 20 completed responses filled in 24 hours, and 10 of the 20 arrived within the first 20 minutes.
- 13 of 20 respondents had never been paid for research before.
- 15 of 20 respondents will go on camera.
- 17 of 20 can join a study within two days.
- Median payout was 18 hours, across 10 payouts.
- Every panelist verifies enrollment with a school email at signup.
- Panelists are picked by hand against the criteria the client sets, and an online screener goes out with the invite. The correct term for the whole process is "closed invite with an online screener".
- Panelists are capped at two studies per month, with a 90 day cooldown inside a category.
- One flat price per completed session, incentive included.

GOVERNING PRINCIPLE

You may describe what Campus Takes does.

You may not claim how well it works until it has worked.